

MULTI-FUNCTION PRINTER

Print, scan, fax. MFPs
are good for all this
and more...

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Whether it's for a small business, office or home use, multi-function printers or MFPs are becoming an increasingly popular choice for budget-minded customers. Here's what you need to keep in mind for buying one this festive season:

EVALUATE YOUR REQUIREMENTS

First and foremost, know what you want to do with the MFP. How many scans, prints and copies will you be taking on a typical day (not week or month)? Home users may want to scan and print photos, students might have to file coursework, small offices will go through tens of sheets of documents every day; while at the same time, professional photographers and large enterprises will have totally different requirements from an MFP. Laser printers are great for printing just text documents, whereas inkjet printers will do greater justice to photos. There is no one-size-fits-all MFP in the market.

TCO

Also known as total cost of ownership, TCO is the only defining value for money metric that matters during the purchase of any MFP. Specs come later, first comes TCO. What it means is that while evaluating a multifunction printer, don't just be swayed by the initial hardware. There are a number of other factors

to consider, including the cost of supplies, ink refills, etc, that need to be weighed in seriously. According to Xerox, "TCO can also increase significantly for devices that are hard to use and maintain, unreliable, or lack the features and capability to efficiently and effectively produce the results you need."

EASE OF USE & CONNECTIVITY

Make sure the MFP you select is thoroughly tested and that you're convinced it has everything you need and you understand how it functions. For e.g. the intuitiveness of its menu buttons, on-body instructions, port placements, depth and breadth of on-screen display (if present), etc. Also make sure the functions you want are actually present – photographers may want a dedicated SD card slot to use the MFP independent of the PC it's connected to, wireless network configuration and access, printing from your smartphone, etc.

SIZE MATTERS

Make sure the MFP is able to scan and print documents and images in a variety of sizes and dimensions, make sure you have everything you need. Also, if you're going to move the printer around, check up on its size. We've noticed that some of the office MFPs can be quite big and cumbersome to move around. 

TOP CAMERA PHONES



IPHONE 5S

Love it, or hate it but the camera on the iPhone is just brilliant with excellent performance.



LG G3

Phase detection/laser auto-focus, optical IS, a dual-LED (dual tone) flash, 13MP. Convinced yet?



SAMSUNG GALAXY S5

A somewhat less impressive phone paired with a superlative camera. Quite a combination.



NOKIA LUMIA 1020

41MP. The resolution says it all. Whatever else the phone is, the camera is just too good to ignore.



SONY XPERIA Z2

An excellent 20.2MP camera is coupled with the ability to take photos underwater. Awesome.

BEST LAPTOP ACCESSORIES



LOGITECH M185

Probably the best sub-1k wireless USB mouse for your laptop, with nice performance and good build.



TARGUS TERRA BACKPACK

This is more than just a good laptop bag and makes for a great travel companion.



JBL CHARGE

A 6000mAh powerbank and a great bluetooth speaker, a great package for you.



COOLER MASTER NOTEPAL L1

A slim, trim but well-built notebook cooling pad which can accommodate large laptops.



SENNHEISER HD 201

The very basic all-rounder for your laptop, with a 3-metre cable. Impressive choice at that price.